

Machine-assisted translation

AR's role in tourism does not end with maps, directions and points of interests. Wondering how else would a machine help you see a world differently when you are travelling? By assisting in translation, of course. Languages serve both as bonds and as boundaries when it comes to communication. When you travel far enough, bonds may easily turn into boundaries. For example, being able to understand your surroundings well, while you are in Spain would require you to understand Spanish. Billboards as well as restaurant menus may become intimidating in no time. Well, you do have a translation app or dictionary on your phone, but are you ready to translate all that you encounter into your preferred language? Well, good luck on your path to frustration and killing the joys of travelling.

AR can provide immense help while you travel by translating any content that you encounter on the fly. There is no need to keep tapping in words to understand what a restaurant offers on its menu. All you need to do is to point your mobile phone's camera at the menu and look at the display and you would be reading the menu in your preferred language in no time. This is achieved through several apps available in app stores, which almost instantly translate content captured through mobile phone cameras. Some of the really clever apps have been able to completely blur the distinguishing points the augmented and real-world features.

One such application for iPhone is 'Word Lens' and we recommend you to watch it in action: <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b2OfQdYrHRs>. We are sure you would love the innovative uses it can have. 